Partners Group Holding AG

Recommendation	Price	12-Mo. Target Price	Report Currency	Investment Style
BUY ★★★★★	CHF 1,041.50 (as of market close Sep 15, 2023)	CHF 1,100.00	CHF	Large-Cap Growth

Equity Analyst Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

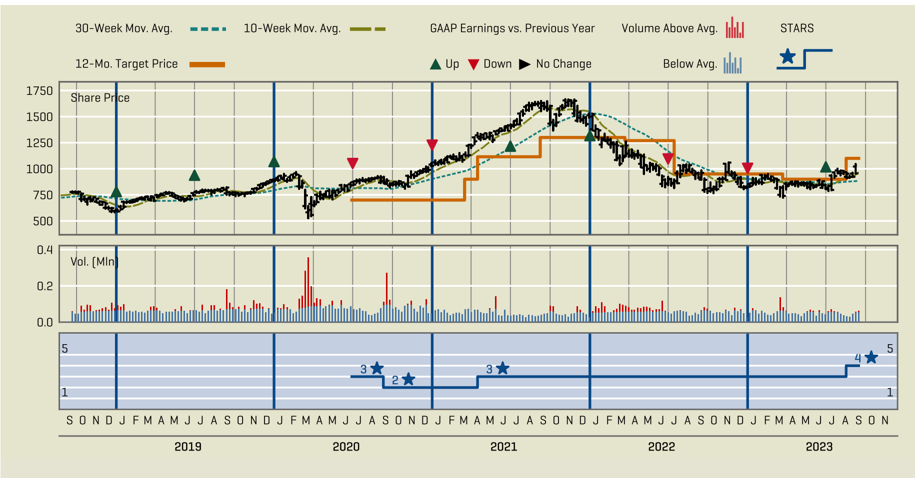
GICS Sector Financials
Sub-Industry Asset Management and Custody Banks

Summary Partners Group Holding AG is a private markets investment manager in private equity, private debt, real estate, and infrastructure assets.

Key Stock Statistics (Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports)

52-Wk Range	**CHF 1059.5 - 722.8**	Oper.EPS2023**E**	**CHF 42.00**	Market Capitalization[B]	**CHF 27.01**	Beta	**1.52**
Trailing 12-Month EPS	**CHF 42.88**	Oper.EPS2024**E**	**CHF 52.00**	Yield [%]	**3.55**	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	**NM**
Trailing 12-Month P/E	**24.29**	P/E on Oper.EPS2023**E**	**24.80**	Dividend Rate/Share	**CHF 37.0**	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	**B+**
CHF 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	**15,827.0**	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	**26.00**	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	**CHF 37.0**	Institutional Ownership [%]	**34.0**

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA** on Aug 24, 2023 02:15 AM ET, when the stock traded at **CHF 921.00**.

Highlights

- Partners Group (PGHN) reported 9% Y/Y growth in assets under management (AUM) to USD141.7 bln as of H1 2023, driven by new commitments of USD8.0 bln (H1 2022: USD13.1 bln). The company invested USD5.0 bln (H1 2022: USD13.4 bln) as it continues to grow its thematic investment pipeline. Portfolio realization was USD5.4 bln, down from USD6.4 bln a year ago, but we think this was commendable given the challenging market environment. We expect fundraising to improve in H2 2023, supported by continuing normalization in the pace of client conversions as well as new strategies coming to market.
- PGHN guides for expected gross client demand of USD17-22 bln in 2023, down from USD22-26 bln it guided previously for 2022. We believe this reflects the lower risk appetite among its clients amid increasing macro uncertainties, which may lead to slower AUM growth. That said, we see improved performance fees for PGHN in 2023 as we expect realizations to recover from the low level experienced in 2022. However, this is subject to market conditions and we may need to wait until the second half of 2023 to see realizations start to materialize.
- We forecast EPS of CHF42 for 2023 and CHF52 for 2024.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- We see increasing demand for investments in the private markets amid an increasingly volatile public market. Despite a challenging market environment, PGHN still managed to grow its AUM. While rising interest rates could potentially lower returns in the investment portfolio, we note that on an absolute basis rates are not different than before the pandemic, and PGHN may have staggered debt schedules, which decrease margin pressure. Increased focus on opportunities related to ESG and sectors underrepresented in public markets (such as industrial digitization) should provide a healthy tailwind to AUM growth, in our view. Valuation is attractive, trading at 2024 P/E of 18.0x vs. its 5-year average forward P/E of 26.6x. Improvement in fund flows is a key catalyst for the re-rating of its shares, in our view.
- Key risks to our thesis include macroeconomic shocks, fee pressure, and negative regulatory changes.
- We raise our 12-month target price to CHF1,100 (from CHF900), reflecting 2024 P/E of 21.2x, above peer average forward P/E of 10.0x, justified in our view by PGHN's superior ROE profile (forward ROE of more than 30% vs. peers' ~10%).

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW | **MEDIUM** | HIGH

Our risk assessment reflects the competitive environment for asset managers and the pressures facing investors in private assets. We consider the increasing competition for private market assets amongst sophisticated investors, use of debt in target acquisitions, liquidity constraints, and overall health of the economy. The risks are balanced by the conservative balance sheet, longer periods of lock-up of assets under management, and a fee structure superior to some peers.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million CHF)

	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	**E** 2,570
2023	1,051	--	**E** 2,125
2022	880	985	1,865
2021	1,130	1,488	2,617
2020	623	785	1,407
2019	682	925	1,607

Earnings Per Share (CHF)

	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	**E** 52.00
2023	21.21	--	**E** 42.00
2022	17.53	21.68	39.09
2021	23.50	31.69	55.12
2020	11.65	18.81	30.36
2019	14.80	18.87	33.66

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount (CHF)	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
37.0000	Mar 21	May 26	May 30	May 31 '23
33.0000	Mar 22	May 30	May 31	Jun 01 '22
27.5000	Mar 16	May 17	May 18	May 19 '21
25.5000	Mar 17	May 15	May 18	May 19 '20
22.0000	Mar 19	May 17	May 20	May 21 '19
19.0000	Mar 21	May 14	May 15	May 16 '18

Dividends have been paid since 2007 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.

Partners Group Holding AG

Business Summary Aug 24, 2023

COMPANY OVERVIEW: Partners Group Holding (PGHN) is a company domiciled in Switzerland whose shares are publicly traded on the SIX Swiss Exchange since March 2006. It was founded in 1996 in Baar, Switzerland, and has offices across North America, South America, Europe, Australia, and Asia. Three co-founders, Marcel Erni, Alfred Gantner, and Urs Wietlisbach, each own 5.2% of shares outstanding, controlling a total of around 15% between them.

BUSINESS SEGMENTS: (1) Private Equity (59% of 2022 revenue) refers to investments made in private (i.e., non-publicly traded) companies. On behalf of its clients, the Group focuses on investing directly in companies that have been identified via its thematic sourcing approach with the objective of transforming them through driving strategic initiatives and operational improvements. In addition, the Group invests in the private equity secondary market by acquiring portfolios of privately held companies and in the primary market through its comprehensive set of investment relationships.

(2) Private Debt (13%) refers to debt financing for private companies. On behalf of its clients, the Group focuses on investment opportunities within sectors and industries that are undergoing transformational change, as identified by its thematic sourcing approach. The Group provides tailored financing solutions to companies that are looking for non-bank financing across the entire debt structure. These investments range from predominantly senior loans to subordinated financing solutions and also span across different regions.

(3) Private Real Estate (11%) refers to investments made in private real estate assets. On behalf of its clients, PGHN focuses on investing in real estate assets benefiting from transformative trends where it can deploy a value creation plan. The Group invests in either equity or debt instruments across several sectors and regions. In addition, PGHN invests in the private real estate secondary market by acquiring portfolios of privately held assets in the primary market through its comprehensive set of investment relationships.

(4) Private Infrastructure (17%) refers to investments made in private infrastructure assets. PGHN focuses on investing in essential infrastructure assets that have clear stakeholder impact, which could be transformed through its entrepreneurial governance. The Group invests across the capital structure in either equity or debt instruments, as well as across regions and sectors.

CORPORATE STRATEGY: PGHN has grown aggressively since its initial public offering (IPO) by pursuing a global presence strategy, diversifying across private market asset classes, and maintaining a relatively high fee structure. The global presence has led to diversity in its client base by type and location, which reduces the risk of outflows in the long run. Its presence across private equity, debt, real estate, and infrastructure means it can offer bespoke solutions for sophisticated investors such as sovereign wealth funds. PGHN has been able to charge a higher fee than some peers as returns on its investments have often outperformed others. For PGHN to continue growing, investment performance and the ability to attract high profile investors are key.

INVESTMENT STRATEGY AND CLIENT OVERVIEW: As of 2022, PGHN has USD135 bln in assets under management (AUM) across private equity (53%), private debt (20%), private real estate (12%), and private infrastructure (15%). AUM growth has been impressive, growing at a CAGR of 13% from 2017-2022. By client type, AUM is split across public pension funds (22%), corporate pension funds (24%), asset managers (23%), distribution partners/private individuals (22%), and insurance companies (9%). Investors are from a wide geographic spread, with the largest clients being in North America (21%), Switzerland (17%), Germany & Austria (16%), and the U.K. and Ireland (16%). Of the USD135 bln AUM, evergreen programs account for 30%, which are funds that do not have a fixed life cycle, but work on a permanent capital basis.

FINANCIAL TRENDS: From 2017-2022, PGHN's total AUM has grown from USD74 bln to USD135 bln. During that period, its private market investments have been fluctuating, but on a generally upward trend, rising from USD13.6 bln in 2017 to USD26.0 bln in 2022. Portfolio realizations have been hovering around USD12.0 bln per year during the period, except for 2021, where it booked USD29.1 bln realization. Profit has also been on a generally upward trend, from CHF752 mln in 2017 to a high of CHF1.46 bln in 2021, before falling to CHF1.00 bln in 2022.

Corporate information

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Officers

Partner, Chief Executive Officer & Global Executive Board Member
D. Layton

Partner, CTO, Head of Technology & Member of the Global Executive Board
R. Schnidrig

Partner, Chief Investment Officer & Global Executive Board Member
S. Schäli

Partner, COO, Co-General Counsel, Co-Head of Legal & Compliance, & Member of Global Executive Board
A. Knecht

Partner & Executive Chairman of the Board of Directors
S. Meister

Board Members

A. Gantner
A. Lester
A. P. Gupta
F. H. Zhao
G. Olivier
M. Erni
M. Strobel
S. Meister
S. Näf
U. Wietlisbach

Domicile
Switzerland

Founded
1996

Employees
1,836

Stockholders
N/A

Auditor
KPMG LLP - Klynveld Peat Marwick Goerdeler

Partners Group Holding AG

Quantitative Evaluations

Fair Value Rank	**NR**	1 2 3 4 5 (LOWEST – HIGHEST) Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued (1) to most undervalued (5).
Fair Value Calculation	**N/A**	
Volatility	**NA**	LOW AVERAGE HIGH
Technical Evaluation	**BEARISH**	Since June, 2023, the technical indicators for PGHN SW have been BEARISH"
Insider Activity	**NA**	UNFAVORABLE NEUTRAL FAVORABLE

Expanded Ratio Analysis

	2022	2021	2020	2019
Price/Sales	11.26	15.34	19.59	14.76
Price/Tangible Book Value	8.89	13.93	12.27	10.43
Price/Pretax Income	18.59	23.27	29.68	22.88
P/E Ratio	20.90	27.44	34.26	26.36
% LT Debt to Capitalization	22.43	21.26	25.44	25.32
Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. (M)	25.71	26.55	26.51	26.74

Figures based on fiscal year-end price

Key Growth Rates and Averages

Past Growth Rate (%)	**1 Year**	**3 Years**	**5 Years**
Net Income	NM	3.75	5.96
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)			
Return on Equity (%)	37.82	43.23	42.24
Return on Assets (%)	15.03	17.39	17.76

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31

Per Share Data (CHF)	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value	91.84	108.54	84.79	85.04	72.81	72.03	56.65	44.94	40.46	31.50
Free Cash Flow	37.99	24.78	42.76	31.12	8.52	28.28	15.20	10.16	17.32	-1.24
Earnings	39.09	55.12	30.36	33.66	28.65	28.09	20.92	14.81	14.24	12.01
Earnings (Normalized)	27.46	40.63	22.13	24.24	20.66	18.77	13.79	8.30	8.95	7.44
Dividends	37.00	33.00	27.50	25.50	22.00	19.00	15.00	10.50	8.50	7.25
Payout Ratio (%)	85.68	49.51	83.06	65.05	65.81	52.82	49.66	56.83	50.08	50.70
Prices: High	1,528	1,667	1,055	895.40	793.00	681.50	508.00	380.00	291.75	273.50
Prices: Low	765.40	1,036	525.00	589.00	581.50	474.00	325.25	224.10	204.40	209.30
P/E Ratio: High	39.10	30.20	34.70	26.60	27.70	24.30	24.30	25.70	20.50	22.80
P/E Ratio: Low	19.60	18.80	17.30	17.50	20.30	16.90	15.50	15.10	14.40	17.40
Income Statement Analysis (Million CHF)										
Net Interest Income	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Revenue	1,865	2,617	1,407	1,607	1,322	1,242	973.00	619.00	574.00	488.00
Interest Expense	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Loan Loss Provision	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
% Expense/Operating Revenue	39.30	36.90	37.10	37.30	34.60	34.60	39.50	42.30	41.30	43.10
Pretax Income	1,129	1,726	929.00	1,037	888.00	847.00	627.00	438.00	413.00	346.00
Effective Tax Rate (%)	11.00	15.20	13.30	13.20	13.30	11.20	10.90	9.60	9.20	8.40
Net Income	1,005	1,464	805.00	900.00	769.00	752.00	558.00	396.00	375.00	317.00
Net Income (Normalized)	705.90	1,079	586.60	648.20	554.70	502.80	367.80	221.90	235.70	196.30
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data (Million CHF)										
Total Assets	4,576	4,833	4,032	3,950	2,949	2,933	1,928	1,501	1,247	1,066
% Return on Assets	15.03	23.27	13.87	18.26	18.38	20.86	21.47	16.23	18.21	17.99
% Return on Equity	37.80	56.60	35.30	42.30	39.20	43.00	40.40	34.00	38.30	40.80
% Return on Common Equity	37.80	56.60	35.30	42.30	39.20	43.00	40.40	34.00	38.30	40.80
% Return on Capital	19.32	29.90	17.58	23.23	23.90	26.72	25.75	18.41	20.85	21.52

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

Partners Group Holding AG

Industry Outlook

We are neutral on EMEA financials. We think the sector in general will benefit from the higher interest rate environment in Europe. This is balanced by growing concerns about the economy, including slower growth and persistent inflation. The recent banking turmoil has also increased the scrutiny on the sector.

For the bank sub-industry, we have a neutral view. We expect the European banks under our coverage will continue to benefit from the higher interest rate environment as inflation rate is still well above the European Central Bank's target of 2%. As banks continue to pass more of the higher rate to their customers, we expect to see expanding net interest margin and net interest income. However, we expect loan loss provision to increase as consumers and businesses will start to feel the negative impact from the tough economic situation. Asset quality will also be tested and we will also start to see increases in non-performing loans. We think that the risk of a liquidity-related failure, such as the one that caused the collapse of Silicon Valley Bank (SVB) in the U.S., for European banks is well-contained, given the high liquidity coverage ratios (LCRs) of European banks as compared to their U.S. counterparts. Investors can take comfort in European banks' capital levels that have greatly improved since the 2008 global financial crisis.

For the insurance sub-industry, we are neutral on its outlook. We see rising interest rate environment continues to benefit insurance companies, particularly life insurers, as it allows them to generate higher reinvestment yields and ease their obligation to meet government-mandated returns on written policies. Also, the heightened market volatility is likely to support demand for pension risk transfer, in our view, as clients seek stability by de-risking their pension obligations. However, we are cautious about slowing growth in gross written premium and higher surrenders for life policies amid an anticipated subdued economic growth in Europe. For P&C insurers, the rise in claim cost inflation may normalize slightly in 2023 but remains challenging to navigate, in our opinion, as insurers' attempt to eke out margin improvement by focusing on underwriting quality may come with the expense of weaker premium growth. Conversely, we believe the outlook for the reinsurers under our coverage is relatively more positive.

We are also neutral on the asset management sub-industry, where we expect asset under management (AUM) growth to slow down amid macro uncertainties. Two of the main positive factors for AUM growth are new products and new geographic markets. Investments that have been made to target new sources of AUM in the retail space more efficiently and to attract new mandates (especially from institutional investors) by offering extended quantitative and big data solutions are also potential drivers for AUM growth, in our view. Despite relatively strong expectations for top-line growth, fee income is expected to grow more slowly, which implies further falls in fee margin (as a percentage of AUM).

Year-to-date through July 20, 2023, the S&P Europe 350 Financials Index was up 8.8%, largely mirroring the performance of the broader market, represented by the S&P Europe 350 Index, which recorded a gain of 8.9% during the same period.

/ Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

Sub-Industry: Asset Management and Custody Banks Peer Group*: Asset Management and Custody Banks

Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. (%)	1-Year Price Chg. (%)	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield (%)	Return on Equity (%)	LTD to Cap (%)
Partners Group Holding AG	**PGHN SW**	**SWX**	**CHF**	**1,041.50**	**27,085.0**	**10.8**	**13.2**	**24.0**	**N/A**	**3.6**	**53.4**	**24.3**
3i Group plc	III LN	LSE	GBP	20.84	19,999.0	7.4	84.1	4.0	N/A	2.5	30.9	4.4
Ashmore Group	ASHM	N/A	N/A	1.92	1,276.0	-0.7	-13.0	16.0	N/A	8.8	9.2	N/A
GAM Holding AG	GAM	N/A	N/A	0.45	72.0	-13.2	-53.0	NM	N/A	N/A	-59.5	N/A
Jupiter Fund Management Plc	JUP	N/A	N/A	1.00	520.0	1.0	-2.5	9.0	N/A	4.0	6.8	5.5
Schroders	SDR LN	LSE	GBP	4.15	6,553.0	-1.2	-5.7	15.0	N/A	5.2	10.4	N/A
St. James's Place plc	STJ LN	LSE	GBP	8.64	4,703.0	-2.2	-21.0	13.0	N/A	6.1	30.2	12.1
Standard Life Aberdeen	ABDN LN	LSE	GBP	1.64	3,044.0	-6.0	13.2	13.0	N/A	8.9	-6.4	9.9

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.
NA-Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.
Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

August 17, 2023
12:40 AM ET... CFRA Raises Opinion on Shares of Partners Group to Buy from Hold (PGHN SW 938.20****):
We raise our 12-month target price for Partners Group (PGHN) to CHF1,100 (from CHF900), reflecting 2024 P/E of 21.2x, above peer average forward P/E of 10.0x, justified in our view by PGHN's superior ROE profile (forward ROE of more than 30% vs. peers' ~10%). We leave our EPS forecasts unchanged. We recall PGHN's update in July, where it reported 9% Y/Y growth in assets under management (AUM) to USD141.7 bln as of H1 2023, driven by new commitments of USD8.0 bln (H1 2022: USD13.1 bln). PGHN invested USD5.0 bln (H1 2022: USD13.4 bln) as it continues to grow its thematic investment pipeline. Portfolio realization was USD5.4 bln, down from USD6.4 bln a year ago, but we think this was commendable given the challenging market environment. We raise our call for PGHN to Buy as we find its valuation attractive, trading at 2024 P/E of 18.0x vs. its 5-year average forward P/E of 26.6x. We see improving demand for private investments amid an increasingly volatile public market. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

March 23, 2023
12:55 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Hold Opinion on Shares of Partners Group Holding AG (PGHN SW 824.20***):
We trim our 12-month target price for Partners Group (PGHN) to CHF900 (from CHF950), reflecting 2023 P/E of 21.4x, lower than its 5-year average forward P/E of 24.6x. The discount is justified in our view by the challenging market environment and higher interest rates. We cut our 2023 EPS to CHF42 (from CHF50) and set 2024 EPS at CHF52. PGHN's 2022 net profit fell 31% to CHF1.0 bln but was above CHF986 mln expected by S&P Capital IQ consensus. The lower result was mainly due to the fall in performance fees (-77%) due to realizations that were brought forward in 2021 and the postponement of realizations originally planned in 2022. This more than offset higher management fees (+12%) on the back of growth in assets under management (+14%). We see sub-optimal returns for PGHN's future realizations due to higher interest rates and macro headwinds. It will also continue to face cost pressure from inflation, talent competition, and investments in technology. Maintain Hold as valuation seems fair. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

July 15, 2022
01:47 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Hold Opinion on Shares of Partners Group (PGHN SW 860.00***):
We adjust our 12-month target price for PGHN to CHF950 (from CHF1,270) on a lower 2022 P/E of 23.8x as compared to our previous forward P/E of 27.0x, justified in our view by the expected lower realization income due to challenging market environment. We cut our 2022 normalized EPS forecasts to CHF40 (from CHF47). In its H1 2022 update, PGHN said that volatile public markets prompted delays in the planned exit of its portfolio of companies, bringing down its portfolio realization by 39% from USD10.5 billion a year ago. Performance fees was 5-10% of total revenues, and we expect this to remain well below PGHN's mid- to long-term guidance of 20-30% until the market recovers. Despite what we think is a healthy appetite among investors for alternative investments (PGHN still managed to grow its asset under management by ~10% Y/Y and is on track to meet its fundraising target), we think its valuation is going to remain depressed in a risk-off environment amid global economic slowdown. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

March 23, 2022
01:58 PM ET... CFRA Reiterates Hold Opinion on Partners Group (PGHN SW 1175.00***):
PGHN's 2021 performance was stronger than we expected, with revenue growth of +86% Y/Y and EBIT margin increasing to 62.8% from 62% in 2020. This was driven by a 17% Y/Y increase in AUM to US$127b from $109b in 2020, and an increase in performance fees (as was expected due to timing of payments). Management expects 2022 AUM growth of between US$22b and US$26b, while tail-downs and redemptions are expected to be between US$10b and US$12b. This leaves us to retain our 2022 estimates unchanged, and we initiate 2023 EPS estimate at CHF50. Previously, we had cautioned that PGHN continues to trade at what we view as excessive valuation on both earnings multiples and a price/AUM ratio. Given the potential of interest rate increases and more economic uncertainty, we have lowered the 12-month target price to CHF1,270 from CHF1,300, derived by applying a P/E multiple of 27x (lowered from 30), to our 2022 EPS estimate. / Varun Venkatraman

September 08, 2021
07:14 AM ET... CFRA Reiterates Hold Opinion on Partners Group Holding AG (PGHN SW 1600.00***):
PGHN's bounce was stronger than we expected, with 1H '21 AUM growing to CHF119b from CHF109b (our previous forecast was for 2021 year-end AUM of CHF119b). This translated to 1H '21 fee growth of +21% Y/Y (management fees +61% Y/Y, and performance fees +39% Y/Y). As public equity markets remain at high valuations and yield remains low in fixed income securities, we think the current trend of institutional investors allocating to private market opportunities will continue for longer. Subsequently we expect PGHN to finish 2021 with AUM of about CHF130b, causing us to raise our EPS estimate for 2021 to CHF43 from CHF36, and 2022 to CHF47 from CHF39. We continue to value PGHN on a 2021 P/E multiple of 31x, to derive a 12-month target price of CHF1,300 (raised from CHF1,115). While the fundamental prospects for PGHN continue to look attractive, we remain concerned that the business is very richly valued at present. / Varun Venkatraman

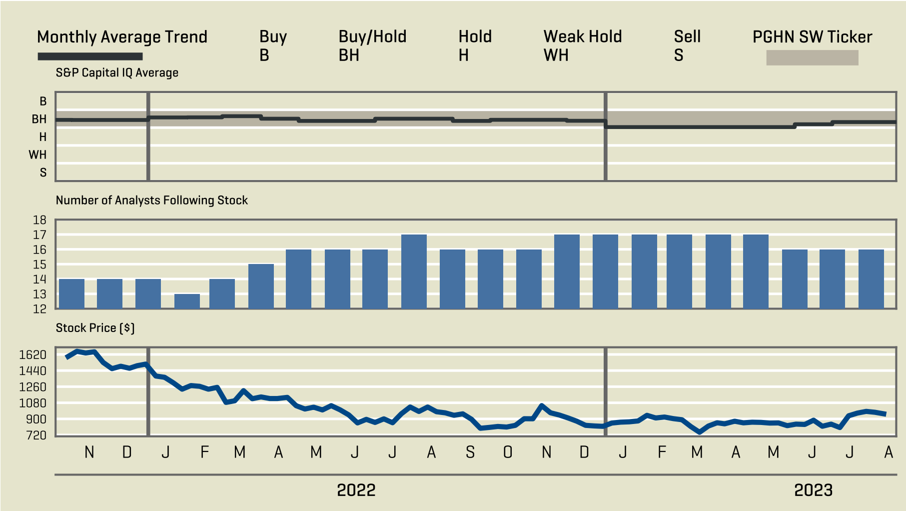
April 16, 2021
06:04 AM ET... CFRA Upgrades Partners Group Holding AG to Hold from Sell (PGHN SW 1321.75***):
We concede defeat on our Sell rating and upgrade PGHN to Hold while raising our 12-month target price to CHF1,115 from CHF900. Our Sell thesis was predicated on excessive valuation, with a potential catalyst being lower performance fees, poor investment performance, or lack of activity in private markets. While we continue to believe that PGHN unexplainably trades at a huge premium to global peers, we accept that the likelihood of a catalyst that could trigger a downwards share price movement is rather low. We leave our revenue and EPS estimates unchanged but increase the P/E multiple in our valuation to 31x from 25x, applied to our 2021 EPS estimate of CHF36 (unchanged). We continue to believe this business may be overvalued but note that overvalued businesses can continue to trade in an over extended manner. / Varun Venkatraman

March 17, 2021
12:52 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Sell Recommendation on Partners Group Holding AG (PGHN SW 1130.00**):
2020 performance was largely in line with our expectations: revenue grew -11% Y/Y (CFRA forecast -16%) and EPS was CHF30 (CFRA forecast CHF28). Assets under management grew to US$109.1b from US$94.1b. Management fees grew at 4% Y/Y in 2020 while Performance fees grew at -12%, this was expected due to lack of activity in private markets during the Covid-19 pandemic. Management continues to believe that in the long-term, 70% of total revenues will be derived from Management fees with the remainder derived from Performance fees. We raise our 2021 revenue expectations on the back of higher AUM growth, which raises our EPS estimate to CHF36 from CHF31, and initiate 2022 EPS estimate at CHF 39. We maintain a valuation approach of applying a multiple of 25x to our 2021 EPS estimate to derive a 12-month target price of CHF900, raised from CHF700. / Varun Venkatraman

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

Partners Group Holding AG

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo.Prior	3 Mos.Prior
Buy	5	33	5	4
Buy/Hold	2	13	3	3
Hold	8	53	8	9
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	0	0	0	0
No Opinion	0	0	0	0
Total	15	100	16	16

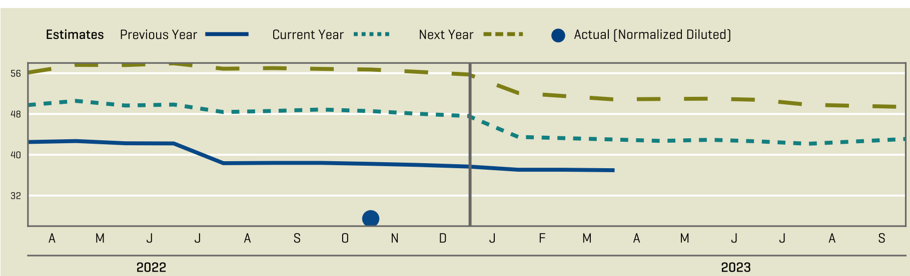
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that PGHN SW will earn CHF 43.11. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that PGHN SW's earnings per share will grow by 14.5% to CHF 49.36.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	49.36	55.32	45.38	15	21.06
2023	43.11	46.49	41.20	13	24.11
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 15%	▲ 19%	▲ 10%	▲ 15%	▼ -13%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Partners Group Holding AG

Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs (American Depositary Receipts), and ADSs (American Depositary Shares) based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS (Stock Appreciation Ranking System), equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark (e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)), based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

(also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**) - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsulize the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+	Highest	B	Below Average
A	High	B-	Lower
A	Above	C	Lowest
B+	Average	D	In Reorganization
NC	Not Ranked		

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus (average) EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
CY - Calendar Year
DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
DDM - Dividend Discount Model
EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
EPS - Earnings Per Share
EV - Enterprise Value
FCF - Free Cash Flow
FFO - Funds From Operations
FY - Fiscal Year
P/E - Price/Earnings
P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
PV - Present Value
R&D - Research & Development
ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
ROE Return on Equity
ROI - Return on Investment
ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
ROA - Return on Assets
SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depository Receipts (ADRs) and American Depository Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ **5-STARS (Strong Buy):**
Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★☆ **4-STARS (Buy):**
Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★☆☆ **3-STARS (Hold):**
Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★☆☆☆ **2-STARS (Sell):**
Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★☆☆☆☆ **1-STAR (Strong Sell):**
Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:
In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.

Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five (six) model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section seof the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of June 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	38.5%	36.8%	46.7%	39.8%
Hold	52.4%	48.0%	44.0%	49.8%
Sell	9.2%	15.3%	9.3%	10.4%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

Analyst Certification:

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